

Codecs

You will also need to install a codec—hardware or software that compresses and decompresses audio and video data streams. Codecs reduce the size of audio and video samples so as to speed up transmission.

First Steps

Set up the PC with the requisite components to facilitate an audio-visual session. Connect the PC to a dedicated ISDN line or broadband connection. Install the

videoconferencing software; ensure that the software on the client's end is compatible with yours. Dial the client's number. Once the two sides are connected, you will be able to share audio-visual data.



2 Web-based Videoconferencing

Can take place using chat software such as Yahoo! Messenger, or videoconferencing software such as Microsoft's LiveMeeting or the WebEx client. WebEx requires just a Web browser and a phone.

3 Videoconferencing Over Virtual Private Networks (VPNs)

Some companies set up private Wide Area Networks spanning large geographic areas to connect branch offices. A VPN uses encryption, and provides a secure tunnel over the network with a guaranteed bandwidth.